THE GATE

Where reality meets virtuality

Issue 7 May 2003



The Newbie Invasion

Find out what's in store for Calypso newbies in this month's Message from MindArk

Legion Pledges Allegiance to Calypso

Meet the veteran colonist

VU from A to Z

Find out how a Version Update is implemented

THEGATE

Issue 7, May 2003

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So long, farewell, Auf Weidersehen, adieu…(that reference is for all you Sound of Music fans out there. Oh, do any of you even know of that musical with Julie Andrews? It's a classic). That's right – this is my final issue of The Gate as editor. Soon enough, I'll be dealing with dirty diapers and sleepless nights instead. I thought putting up with The Gate staff was tough work, but I have a feeling I'm in store for my toughest life assignment yet. I'm leaving the magazine in good hands though when I'm on maternity leave. My colleague Frank Campbell will be running the show from here on in with the help of all our regular contributors. I know they will all do a great job.

I have a vision – I return in a year's time (my old figure intact) to a flourishing magazine loaded with Calypso content, advertisements, and participant contributions. We're well on our way already. The Gate is just seven months old and has already proved to be the best magazine of any MMORPG on the market. Hey, you are ones you told us that. Thanks for all your compliments. We truly appreciate them. Anyway, I'm looking forward to the future of The Gate and seeing it grow.

Seeing as you're not rid of me yet, here is what you have to look forward to in this issue: We are putting a lot of energy into our newcomers to Calypso. We want them to feel welcome and informed upon arrival – that's what we're here for. Helen Praetorius travels to Port Atlantis - the town where newbies get their start. Frank Campbell serves up the goods on IT cafés, Community Manager Marco Behrmann gives us the lowdown on how a Version Update is implemented (we know you're all dying to know that inside information from MindArk), and PE participant and MA intern Legion reviews the Meckel & Loch ML-35. Step inside to see what else we've got in store for you.



That's all folks. I'll definitely be peering through The Gate while I'm on hiatus. I hope you'll do the same.

Cheers,
Stephanie Haines
Editor
The Gate

The Newbie Welcome Wagon

Ever heard of the Welcome Wagon? You move into a new house and get greeted by a gang of your neighbours who bring you cake or flowers, fill you in on all the important information you need and generally make you feel welcome.

That's the plan we have for all of you newcomers to Calypso. This planet is your new home and we want to do everything we can to make you feel at home – greet you, answer any questions you may have, and offer tips on how to get accustomed to your new surroundings. That's why we've created the 'Assistant' on Calypso. If you have recently touched down on Calypso, you have likely met one of our helpful avatars. We know it's tough being transported all alone into the unknown wilderness of a new planet, with little or no knowledge of where or how to begin. That's where we come in. The Assistant is there to answer those basic questions like 'What do I do now?', 'Where am I?', 'How do I run?', 'How do I make money?' and anything else you may wonder about.

If one of the assistants wasn't there to greet you when you arrived on Calypso, we apologize, however we are working on a new plan that will ensure every new colonist will get guidance. The Calypso welcome wagon is going hi-tech. An entirely automated newbie system will be in place in one of the upcoming VUs. Picture it – colonists from Earth will touch down on Calypso at an official landing dock just outside of Port Atlantis where several NPCs will be waiting to provide all the information these newcomers need.

The future is here!

PROJECT ENTROPIA

MESSAGE FROM MINDARK

Version Update 5.0, 5.1 & 5.2

The upcoming Version Update has been renamed due to its extensive architechtural changes. The first portion is set to be implemented mid-month with 5.1 due roughly a week after.

5.0 will focus on lag. Remember the phrase 'Lag kills. Defeat lag'? That has been the mission with this VU. Rubberbanding should be reduced a great deal thanks to the re-write of how the server behaves in regards to synching between the client and the server. This fix will also reduce the load on the databases, plus login and logoff procedures will sped up.

5.1 will be the content portion of the version update. The new feature of Teaming will be introduced. Friends will be able to team up and share loot while hunting and mining.

In 5.2, the focus will be on another form of lag - the type caused by the streaming of buildings, avatars and items. Many sources of the infamous Crash to Desktop problem should also be eliminated.

See the Developer's Posts of the forum on our official website for more info.

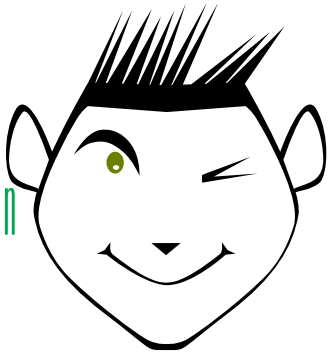
The Takeover

Many of you are likely wondering about the takeover of MindArk AB by MindArk PE AB. Rumours, speculation and a general sense of confusion have been spreading throughout the community, but we assure you that Project Entropia is going to continue so there is no need to worry. Please refer to the news section or the forums on our website for any new information that arises.

VU from A to Z

How a version update is implemented

by Concept Development Manager/Community Manager Marco Behrmann



Roughly every month the virtual universe of Project Entropia is updated, in what is called a "VU", or Version Update. These updates are a mixed bag of content, items, functions, fixes and new technology. But how is this decided upon? What are the criteria of a VU and how are the different parts selected?

The development process is divided into six distinctive phases: Concept – Requirement – Design – Implementation – Test – Deployment. This cycle usually is a running process that is conducted over a six-week period.

Concept

The concept is the idea. The vision. A basic concept might be a sentence like "Project Entropia needs an auction system". Once the vision is discussed with and confirmed by the Concept Development Manager it will be developed into a concept document. The input that constitutes the vision comes from many different directions. Major factors are the desires of the energetic and creative Project Entropia community as well as the development team. The concept department, together with visionary Managing Director Jan Welter Timkrans, is also responsible for many ideas and designs.

Once the concept document is finalized it moves to the next phase.

Requirement

In this phase the developers designated for the task assess the concept and look into what the requirements are to make this come true. Do we need a new database structure, or can old systems be re-used? Does this concept bring a hit to performance and how do we battle it? What graphics and sounds are needed? All traps must be sidestepped and the Team Leader assigned to the task must accept the concept or send it back for modifications.

Design

Once the requirement phase is a go, the Team Leader and his or her team begin drawing up the design of the concept – every bit of the system is documented and scrutinized. When the design is finalized, confirmed and approved by the Team Leader as well as the Technical Director, it moves on to the next phase.

Implementation

No real coding is performed before this phase. The implementation phase is when the design is being realized, code is written, graphics are introduced and music is added. When the designated Team Leader deems the implementation ready, the Release Manager and the Concept Development Manager have to approve the outcome.

Test

Once implementation is deemed ready, various levels of tests are conducted. Use cases are utilized to standardize the process. Both small and large-scale tests are being performed, both by the development team as well as the Quality Assurance Manager and his team on the Project Entropia internal test servers. All issues and bugs are reported, documented and corrected. Once the situation is considered satisfactory, the Release Manager must approve the task or else it is back for further fixes or tune-ups.

Deployment

A task deemed ready for release is put together with other tasks into a VU. The VU is then deployed into the live Project Entropia system. There is usually a downtime while these updates are being applied. A huge amount of data is transferred from the office to the server location in Stockholm, databases are updated and verified, and final tests are conducted before we open up Project Entropia to the participants once again.

What the future holds

We aim to reduce the downtime associated with applying a VU. We are also aiming towards making updates to systems much easier, therefore radically increasing the pace of applying fixes, updates etc.

ANYONE FOR COFFEE?

Frank Campbell



It is believed that the first Internet café in the world was opened as far back as 1984. Even during the early nineties there were less than 100 cafes in existence, but with the explosive development of Internet technology and access towards the end of that decade, the numbers quickly rose to the thousands.

One of the reasons for the success of cyber cafes has been their combination of the comfortable environment of a coffeehouse, restaurant or bar with the numerous developing applications on the Internet.

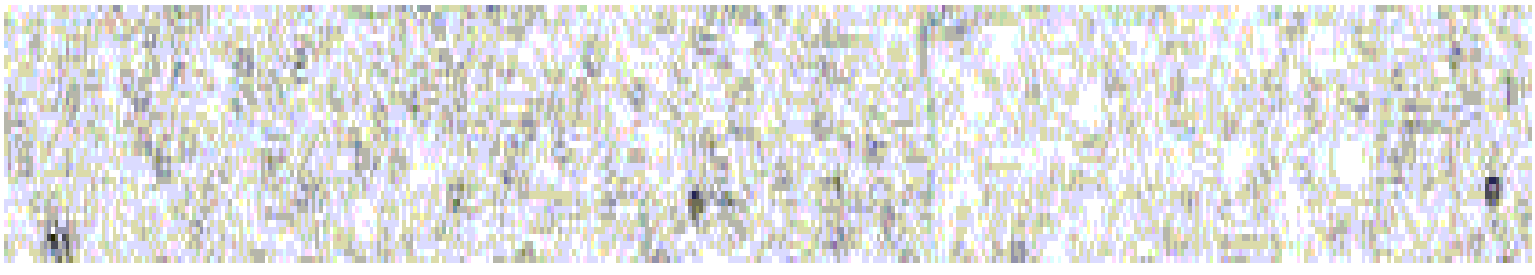
A new world phenomenon, an expression of our universal right to communicate freely with each other - you can find Internet cafés almost everywhere on the planet. There are many sites out there dedicated to this infant industry, and one of the best would have to be The Cyber Café Search Engine at *http://cybercaptive.com/* Here you can find comprehensive lists of cafés all over the world as well as information on how to start your own and what to expect.

It would seem the greatest percentage of people using Internet cafés are those traveling or on vacation. Suffering from separation anxiety, the digital den allows them to reconnect and check their mail, scan a few photos, or most interestingly for us here at Project Entropia – to log into a global network community.

That is the purpose of a new feature section we would like to include in The Gate. After receiving interest and queries from several owners of cafés around Europe primarily, we would like to bring a little more exposure to these havens and the communities that make them work – especially if they are Project Entropia communities. Here in Gothenburg there are several cafés with Project Entropia installed, and one in particular, Game Online, has already boasted several 24 hour marathon PE participants. I've even heard rumours of a possible cK presence there. Connected with a 10 MB fibre optic line, the 30 AMD 2100+ machines use Gforce4 TI-4200 on 19" Sony Trinitrons which has been keeping their customers happy since the beginning of the century (sounds cool doesn't it?).

We'd like to hear more from café owners out there and just like the regular fan and society profiles, we would like to profile cafés from around the world where we can help to get Project Entropia established. We can always help in promoting inter café events and even a little free merchandise to help the cause – supporting the global community of Project Entropia.

Contact us as usual at: *fanzine@project-entropia.com*



eCONOMICS

Economy Specialist Frank Campbell brings us the tips and trends of Calypso's market economy.

Welcome to this month's economy review.

This month's top story would have to be the discovery and exploitation of the automated oil production platform in the southeast sector (coords: x-24329.5, y-8325.9, z-81.3). While on a routine surveying mission, an Omegaton Survey Probe Ship was ambushed by a robot assault squad, forcing the survey team to evacuate the area under heavy fire. In their haste, the production platform was left behind.



The platform has continued to produce oil at a steady rate and this installation has become a popular spot for new and old colonists to get their hands on the allusive free buck. Regularly attracting swarms of Diripi, Atrax and Merp, the platform has witnessed several exciting, if somewhat grizzly, moments. A favorite was when desperate colonists had arranged



themselves into an orderly queue, only to be chewed up one by one by a hungry pack of Atrax, who courteously began their meal at the end of the queue and worked their way up to the top – most polite!

Trading is fiercest at Nymphtown and Fort Ithaca, where almost all ores and minerals trade somewhere between 110% and 260%. Poor results from miners and desperate crafters maintain the inflated prices. In the few months that I've been writing these reports, it seems that Lysterium is always in demand and a good indicator of the economic intensity on Calypso. Reports that certain crafters were looking for Lyst, and prepared to offer 700% for it, should tell you how tense the market is. The advent of the tailoring/coloring system has invigorated the trading of animal skins, so you'll probably be able to get rid of those smelly old hides down in the bottom of your inventory now. Hides can fetch up to 200% so it's probably a good time to do a little spring-cleaning.

The recently applied auction system is up and running. While suffering from a few teething problems, the inclusion of a universal trading opportunity has been a great improvement to Calypso. It's become a lot easier for hunters and miners to move their materials by just leaving them into the auction and resuming their activities. Just click on the 'Auctioneer' NPC when you see him and you'll access the auction system. There are also auction houses in some of the bigger cities on Calypso.

Be sure to tune in next month again when we're sure to have more interesting developments to report to you.

Send us economy tips and trends to fanzine@project-entropia.com

USEFUL URLs

This is where we'll be posting links we think can help both you newbie and veteran Calypsians. If you've got one you'd like to share, send it to The Gate at fanzine@project-entropia.com

ENTROPIA PIONEERS
Great site about weaponry.
http://entropia-pioneers.kicks-ass.org/

SMC
Smith and Mining Corporation
Ore prices, availability etc. etc.
http://www.smc-central.com/

KAZERS TRADING POST
Great place to find a job on Calypso
http://kazer.homeip.net/PE/index.php?page=job

TELUS SAMA MIRG'S JOB CENTER
http://pe-obsearch.tk

PROFESSOR CHRISTINA TALBOTS FIELD GUIDE
All you need to know about the droids on Calypso
http://prof_talbot.tripod.com/

Boxing Bonanza

Saturday, April 19th was the day for Akadian's Boxing Tournament at Billy's Spaceship Afterworld. There were 16 Boxers overall. There was a 5 PED sign up charge that was used for Winner-Take all. The following is a list of contestants: Grunge, Angel, Miro, Sabuk, Burnsey, Goshen, Headwar, Driod, Dekel , De1ta Force, Thark, T Rex, Camelman, Heart, Nay, iulrorck

What an event this turned into! After the first round, these boxers remained: Grunge, Miro, Goshen, Headwar, De1ta Force, T REx, Heart, and Nay. All was going well until the match between Heart (a cK member may I add) and Nay. Heart claimed during the match, near the end, that Nay dealt out 9.9 damage, which is questionable of unfair play, because only TT fists and low level fists were allowed. Although, may I add, had Nay been training, his [Critical Damage] would come into affect. Anyways, all she shouted was "9.9". Of course Akadian had no idea what she meant, until right as she died she exclaimed "f/dmg". It was too late for Akadian to do anything. Once Heart revived she began arguing her case, although rules say she was too late to have this checked out. Akadian reminded her of this. Her companion, Angel (another cK, who lost first round) was agreeing with her. Not having her way, Heart pulled out her rifle and shot up Goshen and Grunge, who were the first Semi-final match (Semi-finalists were Goshen, Grunge, De1ta Force, and Nay). She slew many people, including myself and fellow Gate reporter Dee. She even knew the two of us were just reporters yet she insisted on killing us. Well, Akadian used Private chat to tell the semi-finalists, myself, and Dee, to go to Argus to fight there. Goshen and Grunge were almost done with the re-match when Heart and Angel appeared, once again, killing them. They got kicked off for a short period, but not long enough to keep them from coming back to kill Grunge and Goshen again! That evening, De1ta and Nay fought, and De1ta won. Several days later, I officiated Grunge and Goshen's re-re-re-match and Goshen was victorious. So it would be De1ta Force vs Goshen for the championship and the 80+ PED prize.. The winner, after an unbelievably close match, was Goshen. Hats off to him!







Pictures and report by RP Rave Prospector

What's On Events Calendar

Saturday Night Fashion Fever

What: Akadian's Fashion Show
When: Saturday April 12th
Where:Nymphtown's runway
Who: dozens of Calypsians

Report by Hobbes:
There must have been more people within a kilometer of Nymphtown than has ever been in any one place in the history of PE. My radar screen was mostly green throughout, and everywhere I looked there were people. The psychotropic mushroom spores were especially abundant as I tried woozily to walk up the hill - I could've sworn I saw at least a half dozen people flying above the hill. Making my way into the building and out onto the runway, I spotted Akadian on the end of the runway, trying to herd the crowd into place. A massive group of people had gathered on the ground around the catwalk, strutting their stuff and hoping to be picked.
The winners were eventually picked and went backstage to prepare for their grand entrance. As everyone lined up around the runway, I unfortunately blacked out.

(Gate reporter Dee was also at the event and managed to stick around for the Grand Finale. Thork and Trixie were the winners, taking home 21 PED each. Dee tells us Trixie hopes to start up a clothing line of her own and is already tailoring pants)

Pictures courtesy of Hobbes and Dee.





Men's Winner
Thork





Women's Winner
Trixie

The Race is On

Akadian arranged a race on April 27th. The starting line was at Camp Caravan where contestants began by running and then swam to the horn on the other side of the bay. The winners were Chris (who received 27 PED) and Clockwork. Entry fee was 3 PED apiece.



Picture and info courtesy of Dee

Delacroix Wants You!



If you've got an idea for a brilliant building on Calypso, Delacroix has a proposition for you. Send him your best idea to Mars_b_j@yahoo.dk and this colonist by day, architect by night may award you with 50 PED and design your idea into a 3D model that could one day be seen on Calypso. You never know :)



Party Fit for A Queen

April 30th – Cape Corinth – At least 15 Calypsonian inhabitants, most originally from Holland on planet Earth, gathered on the beach to attend the Queensday party. Cape Corinth was the logical choice for the celebration as it reminded us of Zandvoort, a beach many of us remember in Holland. Queensday (Koninginnedag) has become a day on which people in our old country dress themselves in orange clothes, drink Heineken and party into the night. Since this is all possible on Calypso (except for the beer) we made a group photo at 21:30 hours. After the photos, we moved the group to the apartments on the edge of Corinth. It's not the first party given around that jukebox. I had spoken with the Patron before, and she gave us permission to dance on the tables again. I can really advertise this place for having parties. I didn't even have to pay anybody for rent!
Thanks to all who attended. (Queen Beatrix will receive her photo soon!)



Report courtesy of Camelman
Bottom picture courtesy of Dee

A Find Miss Calypso Event was held on April 22nd. Colonist Debringer was the lucky one who found her. He received 2 PED from the ground and 2 PED from her before they were attacked by Merps. Debringer tried to defend Miss Calypso but unfortunately they both died in the attack.
Info courtesy of Dee

From the Warzone

April 13 - 21

The robots seem to be relentless, attacking Calypso in wave after wave. The settlers have been very successful in defending but for how long will that last? No help seems to be found. Black Legion is dissolved and earth is not sending any help. Will the robots win when the fighting spirit fades from the brave humans?



April 30

The Robots' relentless attacks on Calypso seem to have subsided. Drop ships are still being sighted but the robots themselves have been scarce and no real attacks on settlements or forts have been reported in the last week.
Maybe the robots have given up. Maybe they are building up for a major assault and the first attacks were just for recon purposes. In the meantime Calypso still needs an organized defense and funding for it.





May 4

The robots have resumed their attacks. Reports have come in from Twin Peaks, Fort Meduza and Fort Troy. Stay tuned…

The pictures are taken in Port Atlantis, Fort Troy and Twin Peaks, during a number of different attacks. Our reporter Dee Dee Deranged was in the warzone.

Boxing Bonanza II

May 4th

Akadian again the organizer of this boxing event. The fee was 5 PED each. Not many competitors this time, but a huge crowd there to cheer them on.

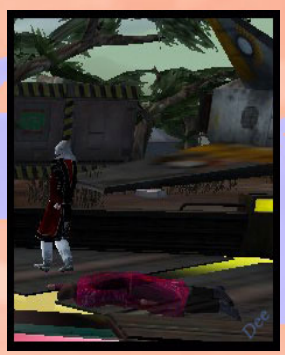
T-Rex won versus Asimaar, Grunge won vs Iulrock and Goshen took down Marco, MA's Community Manager.

Grunge beat T-rex to get to the final versus Goshen. Goshen knocked out Grunge to become the undefeated champion on Calypso!

Marco ready for battle



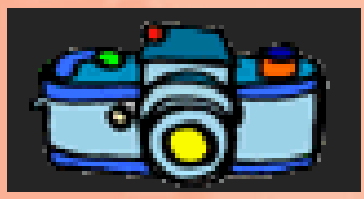
Marco down for the count!



Groshen the Champ!



Info and pictures courtesy of Dee



A special thanks to The Gate's three hardworking photographer/reporters this month. Each will receive 50 PED for their efforts! Thank you to all you Calypsians who applied for the positions.



Dee Dee Deranged

No Picture Available

Hobbes Klivian



RP Rave Prospector

Never Before Seen Games Available Only to Calypsians



Having found the surface of Calypso too dangerous, ShieldBreaker has been busy at the terminal in his apartment, creating games for his fellow colonists.

There are 7 games free for you to download.

- Big Enigmatic Game Company (Stress Reliever)
- When Aliens Attack (Space Scroller)
- Fallen Stars (Casual Family Arcade Game)
- Plus: Galactic Peacekeeper , Luck Bounce, Defend the Surface, Astro Clean-up

More games planned for the future and planned updates for the entire collection.

Check out the selection at: http://kalager.tripod.com



They're hated on Calypso and they love it. The coatKillers have made a few enemies in their attempt to maintain control over the PvP zones on Calypso and ultimately uphold the Imperial Plan.

I'd love to be the journalist correspondent-on-the-scene to take screenshots of the inevitable woeful decimation of cK. :) – ***coelacanth***

The cK are the playground bullies. – ***HeadWar***

I suggest that all players in the PE world overlook them and not to do any kind of trades or deals with them. – ***Mark Paradis***

Anyone want to form a group and chase em out of town with nothing but flaming torches and pitchforks ;) -- ***omebius***

Our interests seem to be on a head-on collision course – ***Buzzi, founder Soldiers of Fortune***

cK's response to retaliation is simple – bring it on. "With regards to civilian resistance, there has only been one honorable attempt to question cKs defense capabilities. It's fair to say that cK enjoyed the testing of their systems, and regarded our performance as extremely successful, with no fatalities, and complete extermination of opposing forces," says society head Demosthenes. "There are frequent rouge violations to cK mandates, but each results in their ultimate demise."



Some may argue this small society's bark is worse than its bite, but The Gate has yet to learn of another group claiming victory over them.

It all started about three months ago when six Calypso colonists happened to meet up in the new PvP zone and didn't actually take each other out – they just chatted. Demosthenes says it made sense to band together rather than stand alone. The other five original charter members are Angel, Heart, Lameth, Linzey and Rei. "Civilians should commit these names to memory, for they, along with their cK advisors, hold the survival of the human race in their hands," boasts Demosthenes. Recently, another six colonists have been accepted into this tight-knit group. "It's a common misconception that society success is determined by size…cK will expand as long as quality civilians present themselves, and the resources are available to supply us." There are apparently very stringent (top secret) skills and equipment requirements to be met in order for colonists to even apply for membership.



cK's short term mission states 'We seek full control of the PvP zones and exclusive mineral rights therein using firepower dominance and supreme skill.' In its early days (three months ago), cK claimed the original PvP zone to take advantage of the abundant mineral and fauna resources. Then when the second PvP zone opened up housing an oilrig, it was time to move. Today Demosthenes says the areas hold little value. "Although cK is still capable of enforcing our mandates in PvP, it would be unwise and cost inefficient to do so." The society's top priority is to protect the natural resources of Calypso from criminal colonists or worse, the robots.

Demosthenes claims the biggest threat to cK at present isn't other societies, but the new quantum AI programming the robots have developed. The Warrior Warlock Generation 06 Assault Bots have apparently proven 'quite challenging'. Whoever the enemy – whether it be human, animal or mechanical – the coatKillers seem up to the challenge. Only time will tell…

If you're wondering about the name, the story is pretty plain. The group was always seen killing colonists while clad in trench coats. What else is there to say? The name just stuck.

To read more about cK, log onto their site at: http://www.truantduck.com/ck/

A society profile by Stephanie Haines



may review

the meckel & loch ml-35

by legion

The Meckel & Loch ML – 35 is of course manufactured by Meckel & Loch as the name implies. The ML – 35 is a really good gun if you have the skill to handle it. Its damage is high and the range is also pretty impressive. It does suffer a bit from a slow fire rate and is also a little on the costly side due to its relatively high decay.

As most of you know the Meckel comes at quite a high price - 600 to 800 PED is the going rate. (I got a good deal on my Meckel some time ago. I only paid 490 PEDs for it, so if you are lucky enough to see one cheap BUY IT!) Is today's Meckel price fair, you might ask? Well it depends on what you are in the market for. You get a gun that has got some punch and a good range but mostly you get a gun that is cool. It looks cool, it sounds cool and yep, YOU look cool when using it. For me it's not so much the damage it deals or the range. For me it's all about image! If I was to sell my ML – 35 it wouldn't be sold cheap… let's just say affection value.

Some of you Calypso residents may actually be lucky enough to loot a Meckel yourselves. So what drops it?? Well that information is for this hunter to know and you to find out…

So let's sum it up then:

Damage: 4/5
Range: 3½/5
Firerate: 3/5
Decay: 2/5
Looks: 4½/5
Sound: 5/5
Price about 600 – 800 PED+ depending on its condition.

Is the Meckel worth it? If you want to look cool and have a gun that kicks arse then it is the weapon of choice for you. If you're worried about spending a few PEDs on repairs and don't care about looking cool then the answer is probably no. If you don't want the Meckel due to its high decay, may I recommend the Starkhov or a Sweeper if you like BLP guns. Both have a bit less range and decay, but are still good quality rifles.

PS. I just heard a rumour about another version of the ML – 35. Whether it is a Unique or Improved or Adjusted model I do not now, but the rumour comes from a very reliable source…



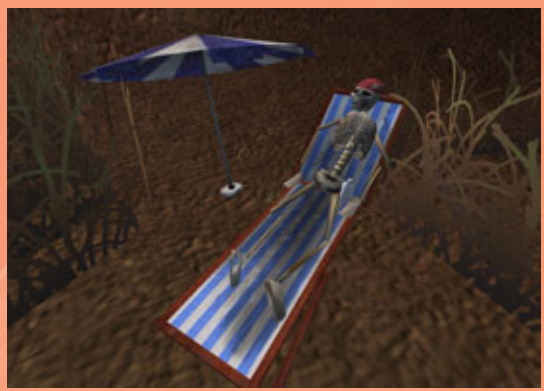


"O.K., obviously you are very angry. However, I feel that we can discuss our differences in a calm and mature manner...perhaps over coffee?"

The winning caption for April's contest comes from Altair 'AA' Anicus. This Calypso colonist now has 30 PED courtesy of The Gate and Two Raven Services. Congrats!

caption contest

This month's screenshot comes courtesy of Pirre. He calls it 'The Boring Tourist', but we are looking for your clever caption. Send us the winner and you'll receive 30 PED to play with. Mail your contribution to fanzine@project-entropia.com



THE TRAVEL GUIDE

Helen Praetorius









Port Atlantis

Finding a secret hideaway that offers a combination of tranquility, history, natural beauty and seclusion requires ingenuity. On the southwest chores of Eudoria in the Erebus Region lies Port Atlantis - a fast growing town that offers all these things. This expanding seaside community has an ideal location on both sides of a river outlet that spreads out into the sea. This outlet is forming a small delta of picturesque islands. One of the major reasons this is developing into a town is its beautiful location.

Port Atlantis is also known for being 'newbie-land'. That's right - this ever-growing community is the birthplace to all new colonists on Calypso. If you are looking for a new place to explore and possibly make new friends, this is it. Just follow the orange brick road…well, just follow the sea of orange uniforms. The newcomers usually hang out by Port Atlantis teleporter or they gather where they get 'beamed' in south-east of town at X=6080, Y= 8010, Z=17.5.

It is at this location that we supply an information service to help our newly arrived Calypsians get acquainted with their unfamiliar surroundings. Once they have gathered some info upon arrival, the entire continent is at their feet ready to experience. However, the 'Assistant' usually advises the newcomers to stop by Port Atlantis to chat with other participants first before they head off into the wilderness. They can always come back to their spawn spot if they have further questions. The information service will remain – whether it be a real 'Assistant' or an NPC.

For any colonists who plan on settling in Port Atlantis, you may want to know of the industrial potentials that lie within this community. These are mainly focused on extracting resources from the sea, primarily fish for making food products. Fish farms are a perfect example of what will be used for this purpose. Another feature that will eventually turn Port Atlantis into a very popular resort is the sport fishing. Industrial sea platforms used for underwater mining operations can also be found around here.

With lots of new people and plenty of things to do, one can't go wrong by heading here. I would get myself to the nearest teleporter and say 'Beam me up, Scotty' – to Port Atlantis that is.

participant profile

Helen Praetorius Meets Legion





In this month's issue of The Gate we are focusing on Calypso's 'newbies', but we shouldn't forget about our 'oldies'. That is why I am profiling Legion. I'm not saying that he is old literally, but he would definitely be among the most persistent and long-term participants of Project Entropia.

Legion set his foot on Calypso a long time ago. The planet was still in the development stage called the Commercial Open Trial. For the first year he kept traveling back and forth from earth to Calypso, but over the last four months he has been enjoying his life on Calypso to the fullest (with some 1200 logged hours from January to late March). The reasons Legion decided to settle on Calypso were "the free ride and then the possibility to make some hard cash while exploring this awesome planet." He says it's also fun to make new friends, which he does on a daily basis. Legion is an experienced traveler to other planets like Europa in the universe of Ultima Online and EVE, but has not yet been to one comparable with Calypso.

Legion's passion is mining. He sees it as being the main profession affecting Calypso's economy in the future, although it has been a bit difficult to find ore lately. "I do think the mining will be better again. I think it might have been due to the planet going through some major changes due to the terraforming being done on it." In the meantime he has been hunting with his Meckel & Loch ML-35. Legion has notified Calypso authority Marco about this and about some environmental concerns, one being the gravity changes which make colonists bounce back and forth sometimes. "I have heard some nice rumors about this being fixed by the terraformers though," says Legion. "I'm actually not exactly sure what it was I heard since I was quite intoxicated at the moment while visiting a bar on the surface of Calypso. A miner has to be able to have some fun from time to time and not always be working you know."

When Legion isn't busy working hard, he dedicates himself to a society called Soldiers of Fortune. Initially he had plans to create a society of his own with a friend, but he decided to work on another planet. This left Legion on his own wandering the surface of Calypso. He had heard about SOF so he decided to check them out. "This was late last autumn I think. From then on I have become their mining leader and I'm in charge of their mining operations." Legion has high hopes for the society. He sees SoF as a thriving and rich society in a year's time, with many more members and troopers plus their own place to run operations from on Calypso.

One piece of advice this veteran would give to newcomers is to join a society (SoF perhaps?). Legion says a lot of good information is being hidden inside these and it is important to listen to fellow colonists in the beginning, "Knowledge is essentially VITAL on Calypso." Another tip Legion offers is to spend hard earned PEDs wisely. "Don't run off and buy the best gun and armor you can find…buy an Outbacko with your first PEDs and hunt easy prey."

'It's the money that makes it real' has become Legion's catchphrase. With a slogan like that, let's hope the terraformers do everything in their power to reach the expectations of our dear 'oldie' Legion and the rest of our colonists settling on Calypso.

If you want more information how to join SOF you can find them in the irc channel or check out their new (soon to come) website: http://ww.sofltd.com

Helen Praetorius

Calypso Fashion

This time around I have decided to take a look for myself on Calypso and see what the fashion trends are. I was able to assemble some interesting information with the help of my undercover resources.

First of all it was nice to discover that the interest for fashion and design is huge. People are well aware of the different brand names and styles available on Calypso. There have been quite a few fashion events held recently, including a couple of fashion shows. This has also made people aware of the different styles that are hot. So let's hear what some of them have to say! My first impression when I look around is color. Colonists seem to be crazy for color, and there is a mix of everything from bras, minis, skirts, coats, etc. Despite all the color variety, I managed to find out that black is still super popular among fellow Calypsians. It never seems to go out of style.

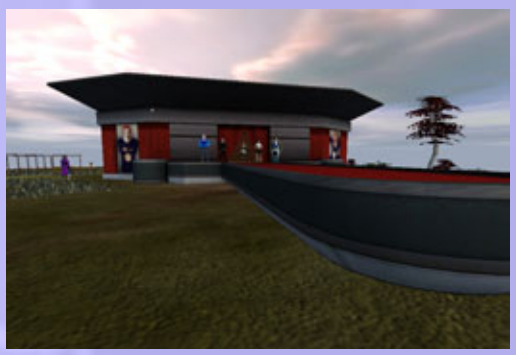
I also discovered certain articles of clothing are quite the hot commodity. So what are they? According to a lot of colonists I spoke to, skirts will always be a piece most female participants like to get their hands on. For men it is the trench coats and other jackets that are on the most-wanted list, usually the ones with a thin design. A brand name that is pretty hot is Luna Line solar, plus the clothing shop in Hadesheim called Occult, showcasing its different designers/ styles.

Most of the clothes colonists loot they actually sell, so trading items of clothing is a business well established. A female I met named Whoopy is a very busy clothes trader and she usually hangs out in Jason Center. Just like in the real world, new and unusual articles are always in high demand.

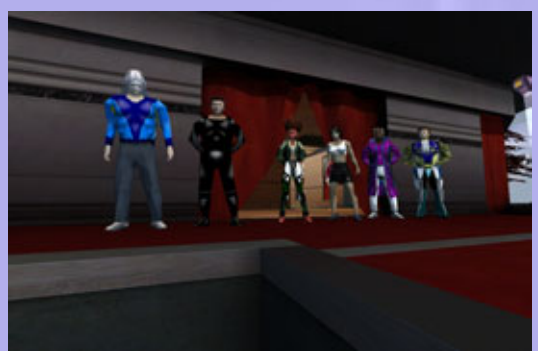
There is now an opportunity for colonists to be very unique with the new tailoring system, which allows them to play around with their own imagination. The feeling of looking like everybody else is not so appealing for most people. In fact one of the first things that our newcomers always ask is "Where can I get some cool clothes from?"

Another interesting discovery I made was that there are quite a few people around who would like to have something really stylish to wear, but that can also protect them from the "wildlife" on Calypso. Armor crafters, take note!

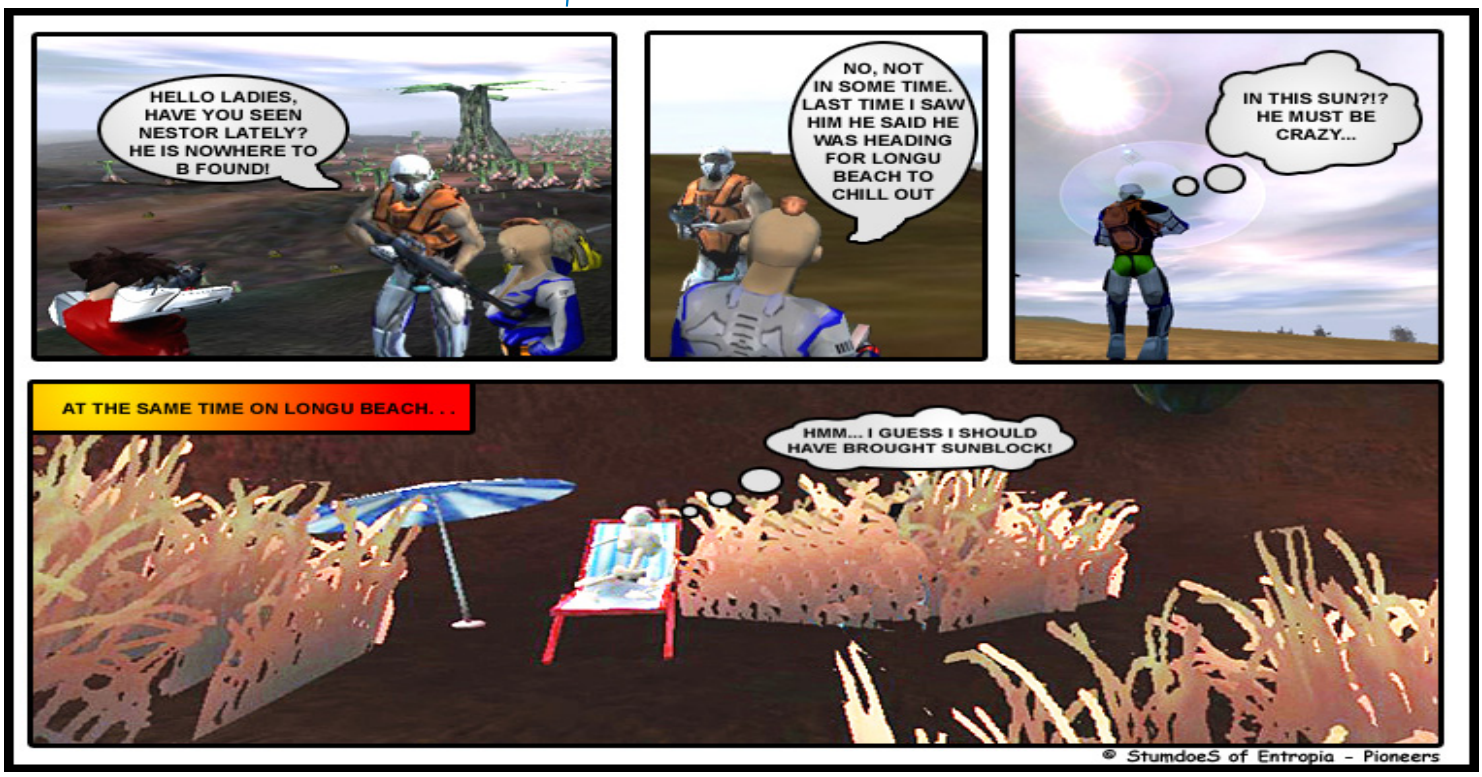
Taste is something that will always vary among people; it changes with time, through influences and experiences. That is what makes Calypso such an interesting place. It's great to see so many inspiring minds out there with great taste and imagination.







CALYPSO COMIC courtesy of StumdoeS



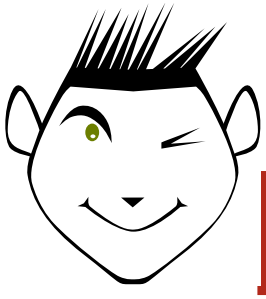
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